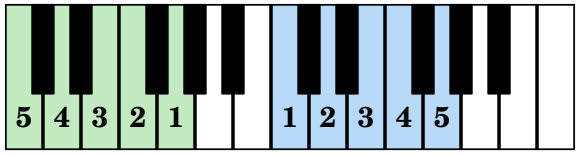
Unit 4

Skips

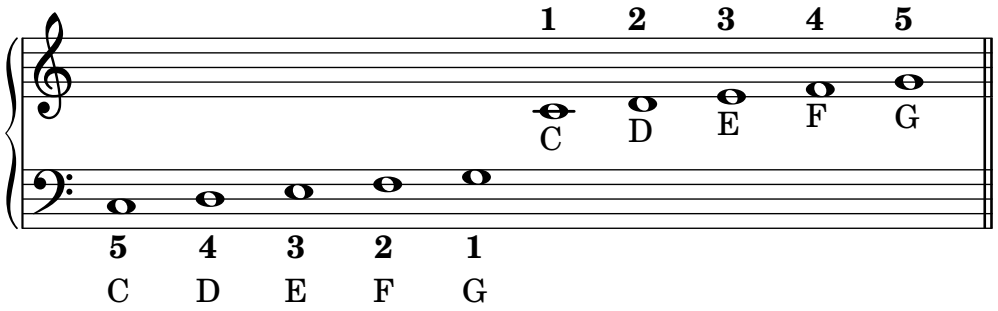
New: Thirds: line-to-line and space-to-space

Until now every melody moved by step or stayed on the same note. Now notes can skip: jump over one key, and over one finger. Both hands are still in C position, so a skip never needs a hand move.



Left hand C position and Right hand C position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes



What is new

The skip (a third)

A skip jumps over one white key and one finger: C to E, D to F, E to G, and back down.

Skips on the staff

A step always goes from a line to a space or from a space to a line. A skip goes from a line to the next line, or from a space to the next space.

Fingers for skips

Skips use every other finger: 1 to 3, 2 to 4, or 3 to 5.

Chains of skips

C, E and G can follow each other. In the treble clef they sit on the ledger line, line 1 and line 2; in the bass clef they sit in three spaces in a row.

Reading tips

1. In your 10-second scan, look for pairs of notes that are both on lines or both in spaces. Those are skips.

2. Think of a skip as a finger jump (1-3, 2-4, 3-5) rather than naming the new note.

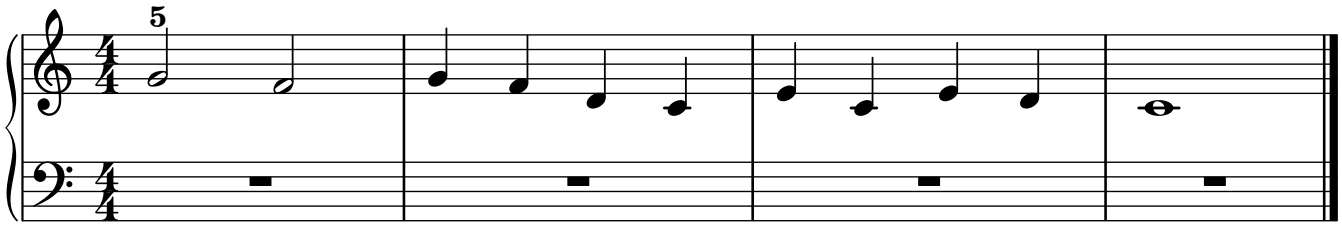
3. Spot chains: line-line-line, or space-space-space, is C-E-G. Read it as one shape.

4. If a skip catches you out, keep the beat and carry on. Accuracy improves with more reading, not with stopping.

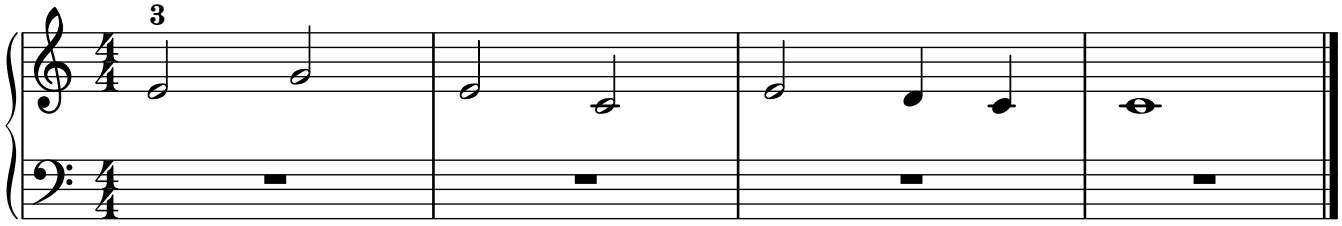
Part A: Right-hand skips ♩ = 60

Skips in the right hand, mixed with steps. Metronome 60.

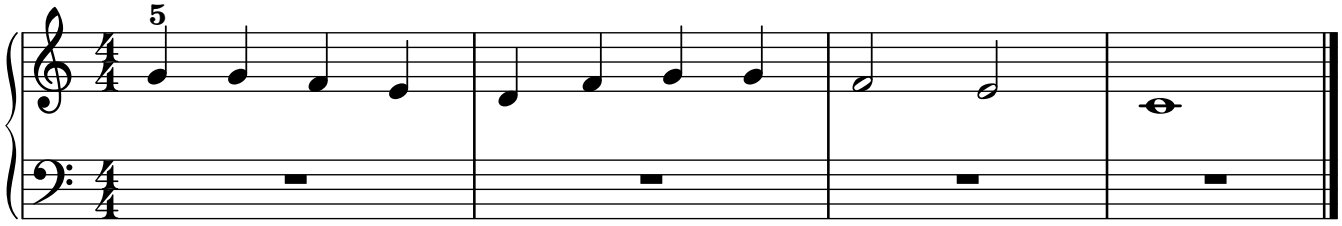
☐ **4.1**



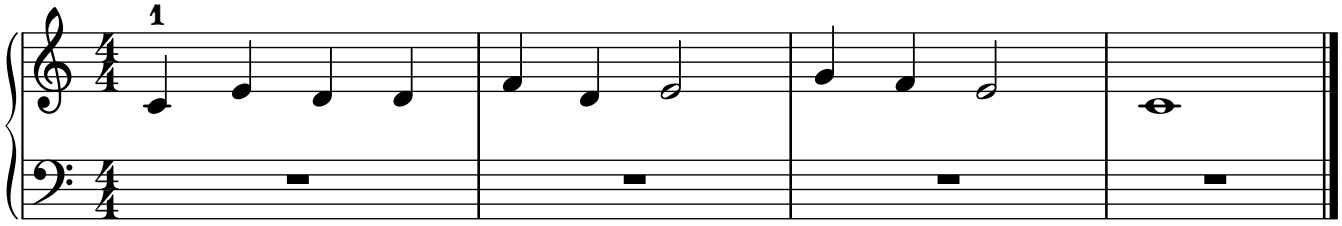
☐ **4.2**



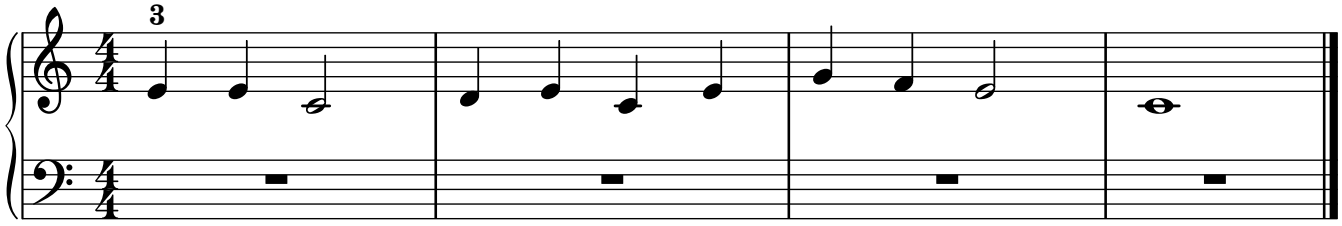
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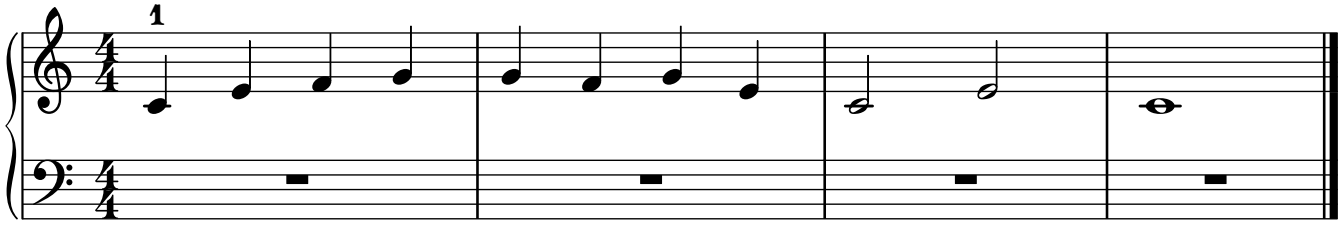
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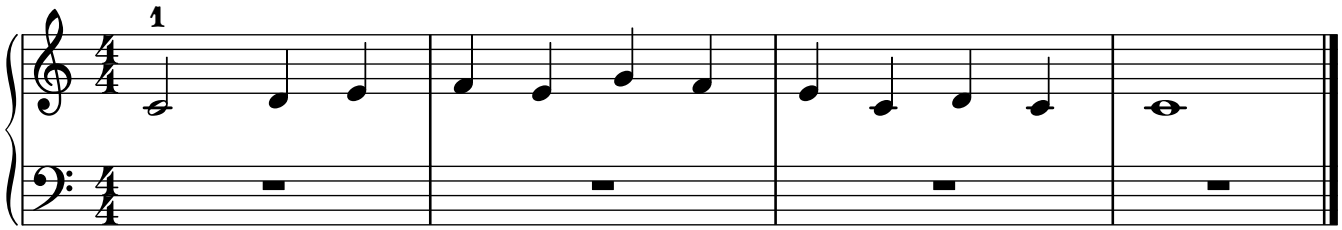
☐ **4.5**



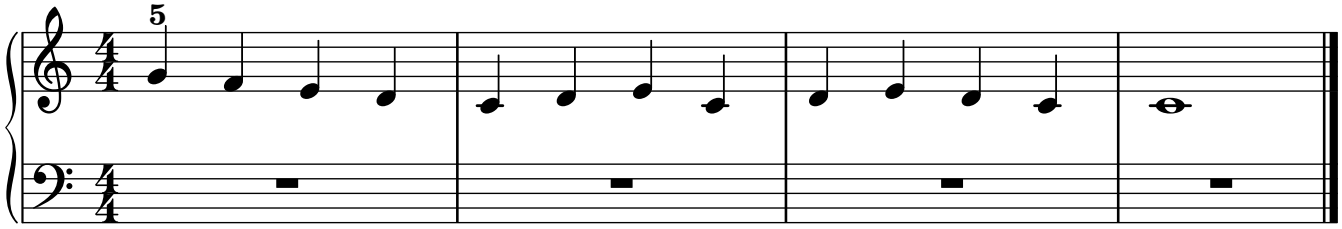
☐ **4.6**



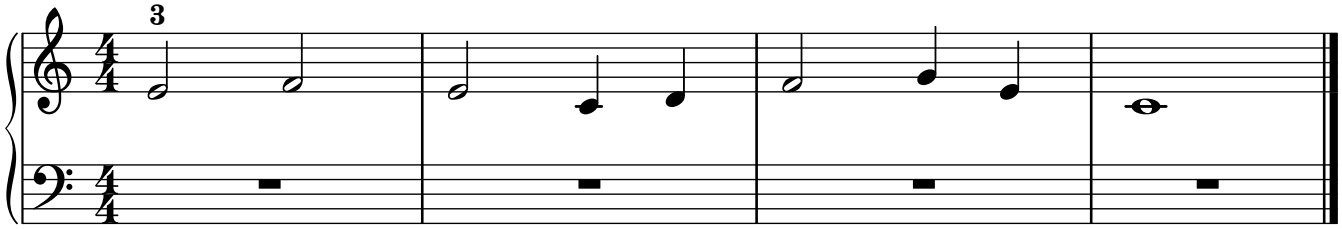
☐ **4.7**



☐ **4.8**



☐ **4.9**



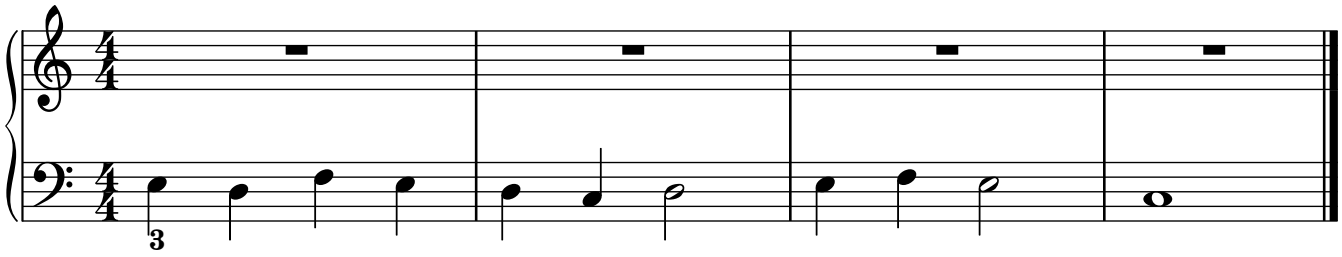
☐ **4.10**



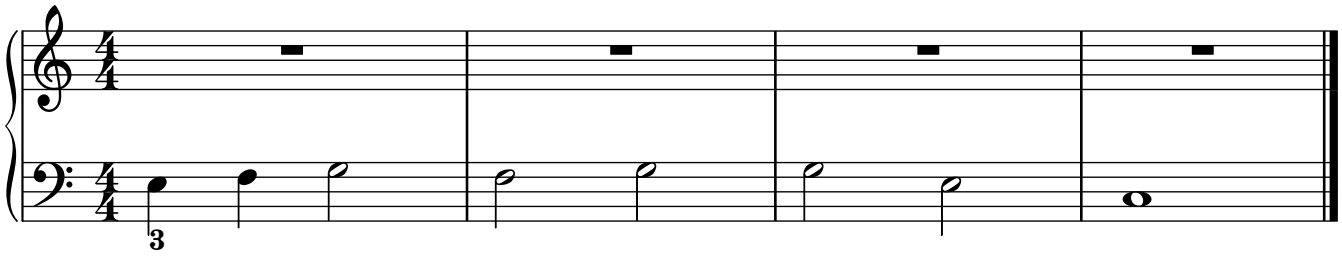
Part B: Left-hand skips ♩ = 60

Skips in the left hand. In the bass clef, C, E and G sit in the second, third and top spaces.

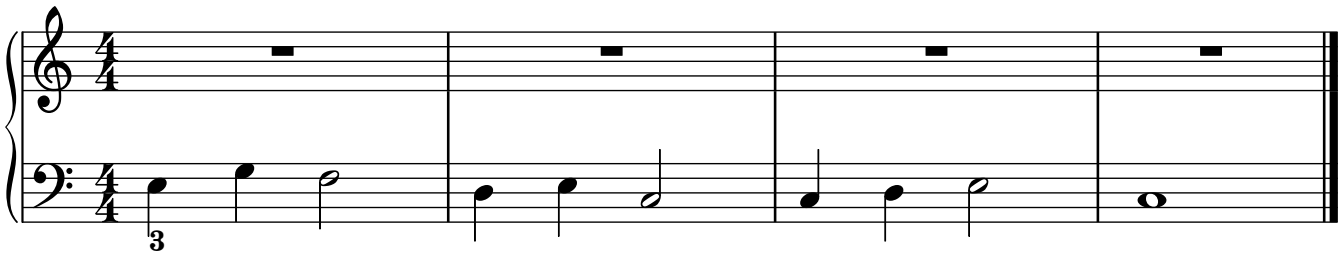
☐ **4.11**



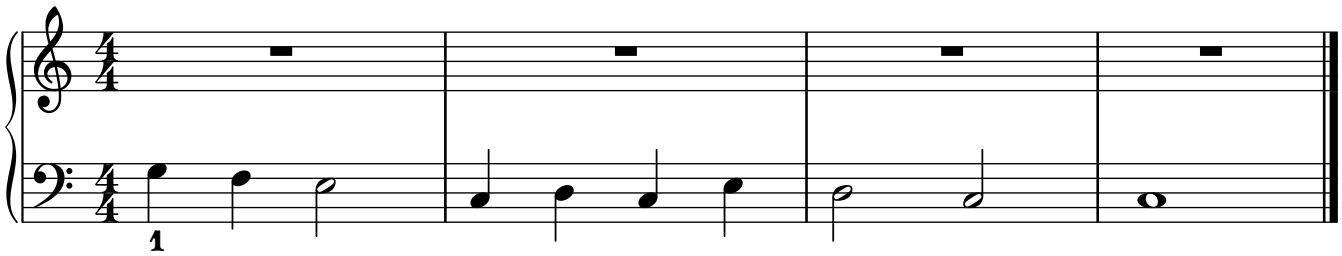
☐ **4.12**



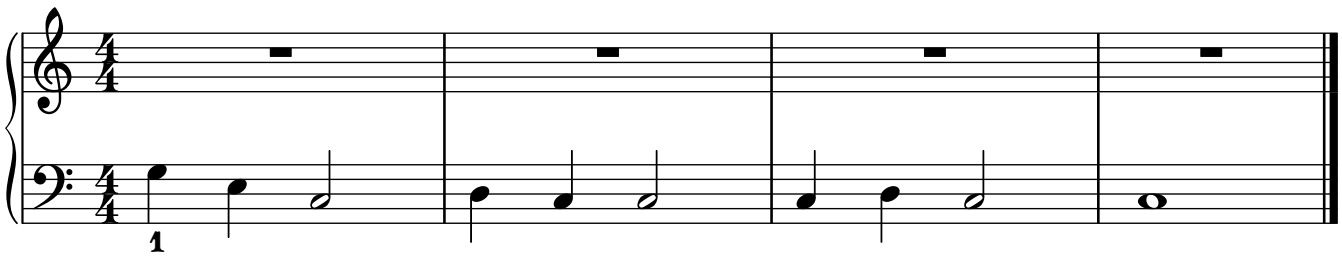
☐ **4.13**



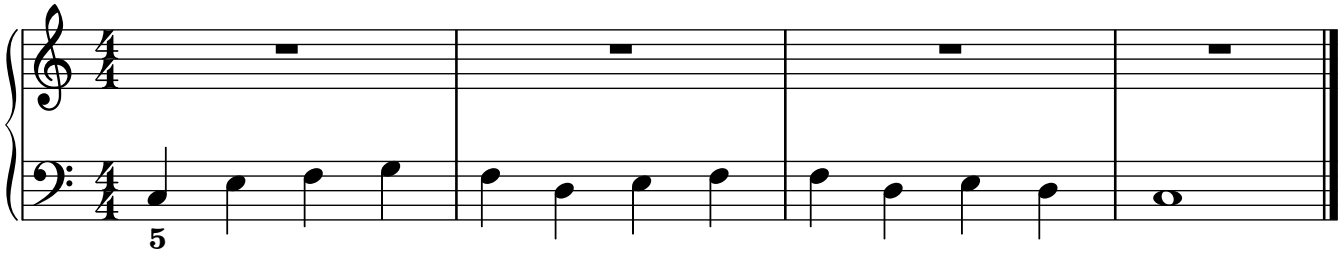
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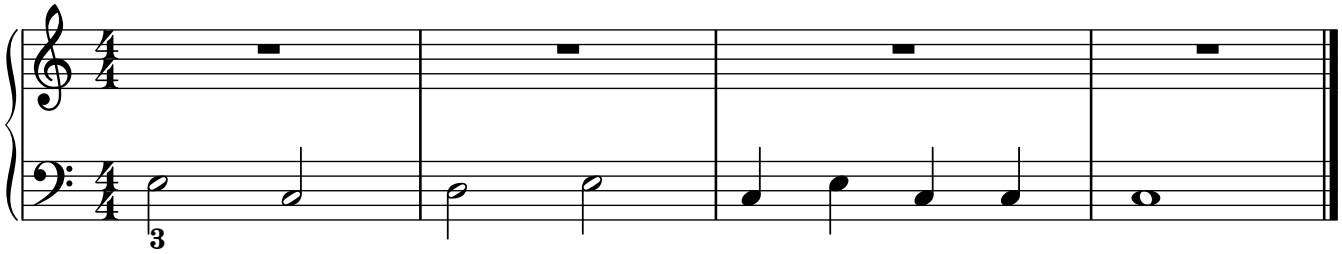
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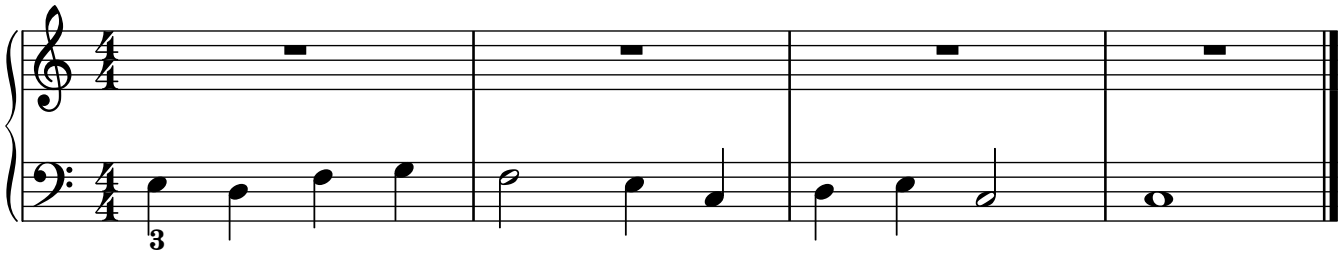
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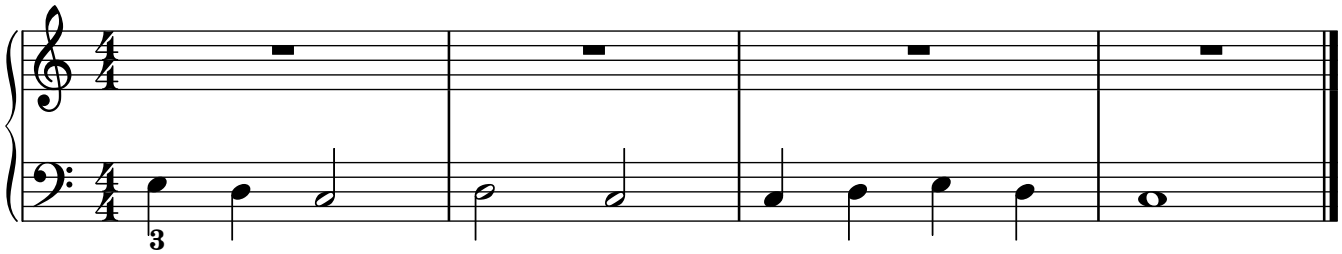
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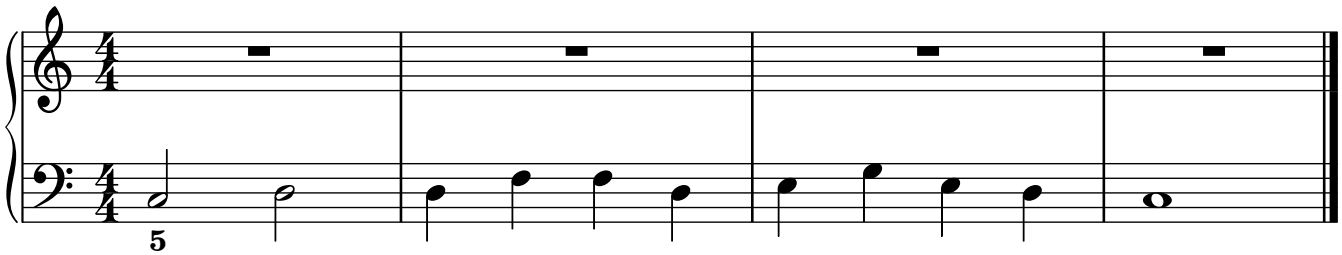
☐ **4.18**



☐ **4.19**



☐ **4.20**



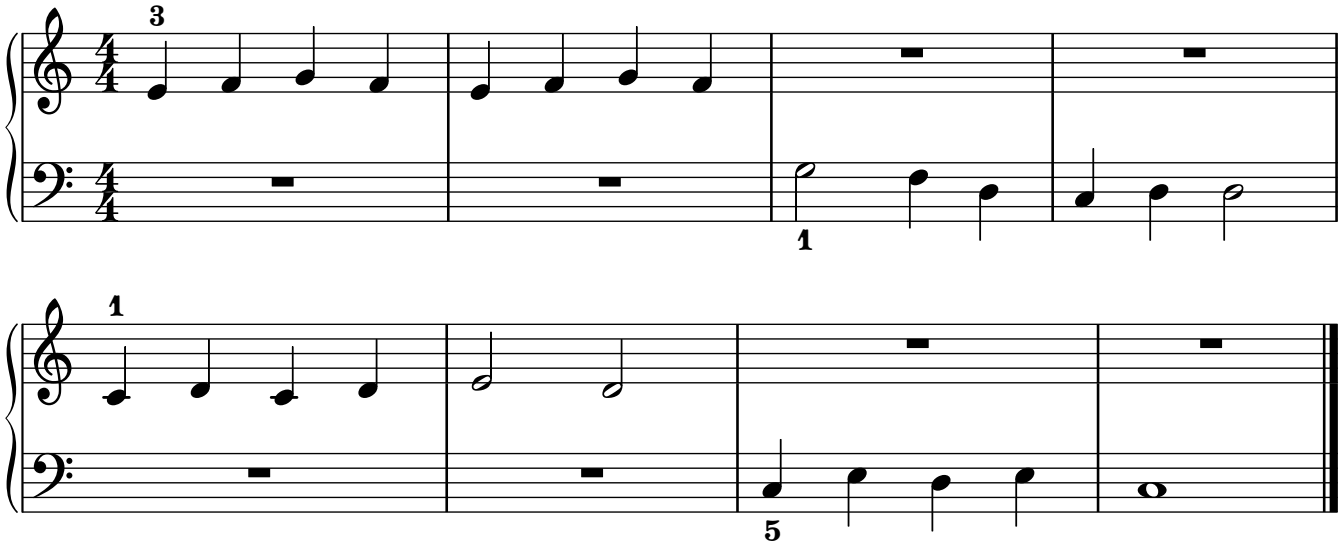
Part C: Skips, hands taking turns ♩ = 66

Skips with the hands taking turns, in eight-bar phrases.

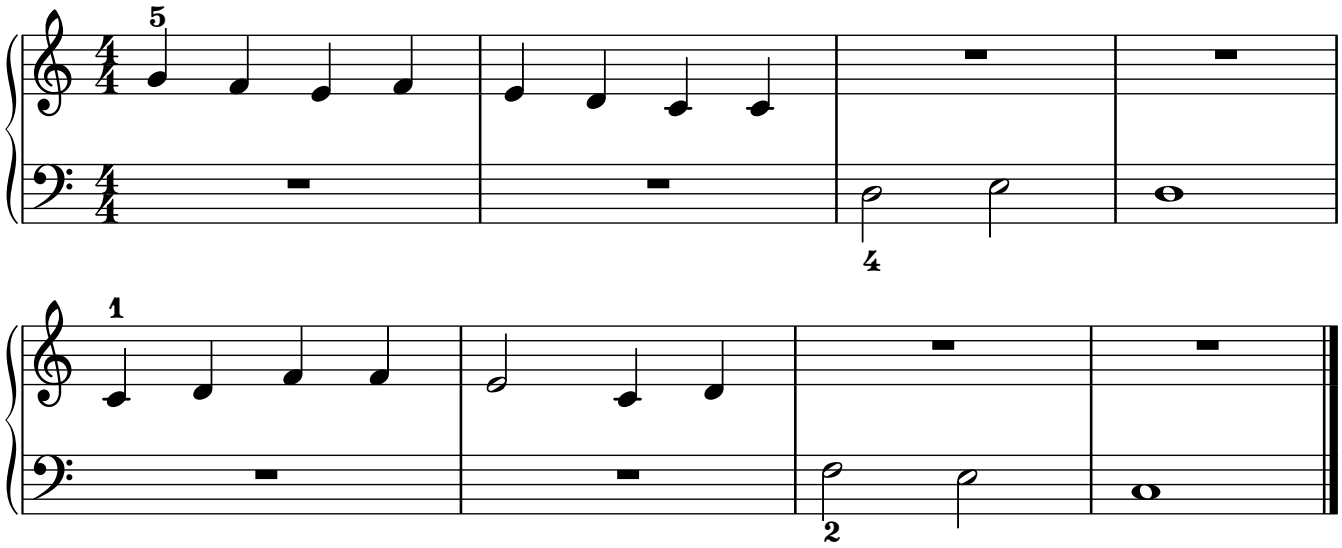
☐ **4.21**



☐ **4.22**



☐ **4.23**



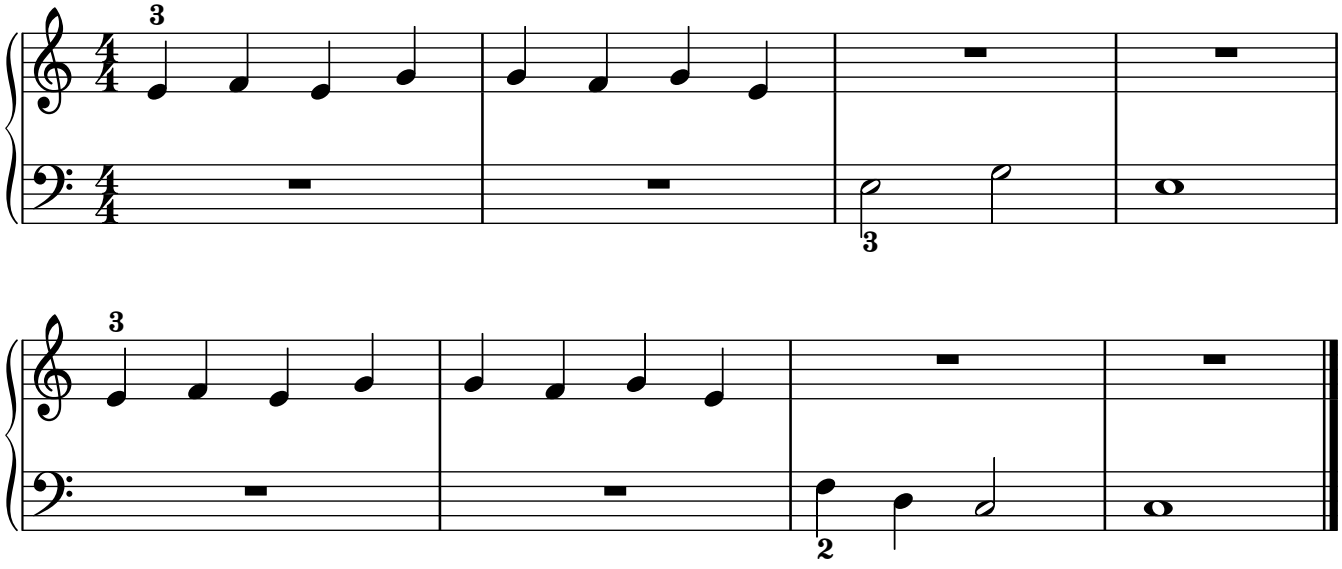
4.24



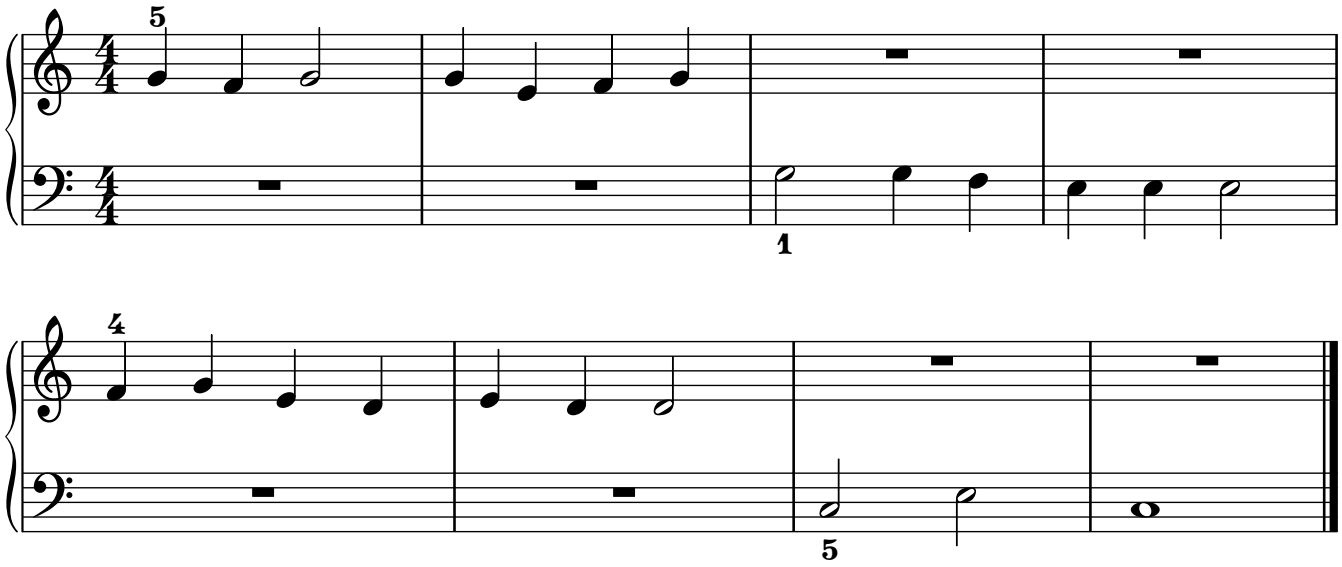
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4.26



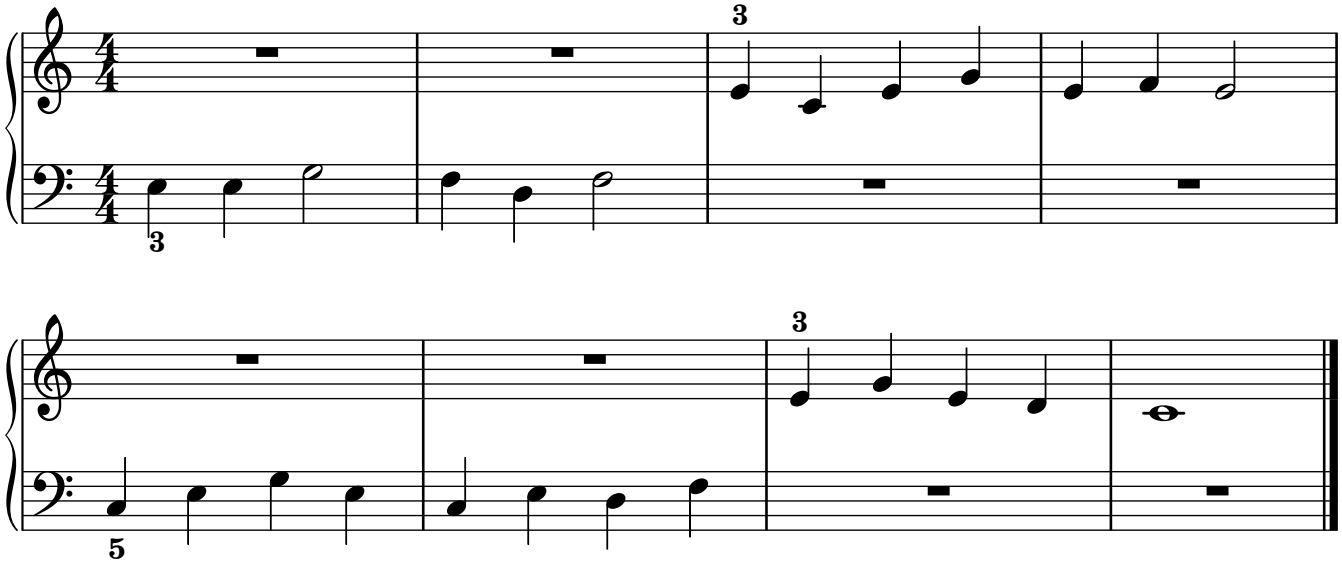
4.27



4.28



4.29



4.30



4.31



4.32



Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Mary Had a Little Lamb ♩ = 84

Traditional

One skip only: E up to G in bar 4. Everything else moves by step or repeats.



Au clair de la lune ♩ = 76

Traditional French song (opening)

The right hand sings the phrase, then the left hand repeats it. Find the skip in bar 3 before you start.



Leapfrog ♩ = 72

Original

Skip, step, skip, step: the right hand hops up, then the left hand hops down from G.



Stepping Stones ♩ = 88

Original

Each bar steps down and then skips up, like crossing a stream on stones. Lean on beat 1.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 5?

- Play five Part C exercises you have not played before, at 66 beats per minute.
- Pass if you keep the beat going, with no more than one stop per exercise.
- Pass if you play the skips without looking down, and at least 9 notes out of 10 are right.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 5, where both hands play at the same time.